

04

OPENING LINES

50 Powerful Hooks

Fill-in-the-blank opening lines in 8 styles — each with a worked example from a different niche.

50

HOOKS

8

STYLES

50

EXAMPLES

[START HERE](#)

How to use these hooks

A hook is the first thing people see: the first line of a caption, the cover of a carousel or the first two seconds of a video. These templates give you a proven starting structure.

01

Pick a style

Match the hook style to your content: a mistake post needs a mistake hook.

02

Fill the blanks

Replace the placeholders with specific words your audience uses.

03

Keep the promise

Make sure the content delivers exactly what the hook suggests.

Rules for honest, effective hooks

- **Specific beats clever.** “3 mistakes new runners make” is stronger than “Running secrets revealed”.
- **Short beats long.** Aim for under 12 words; cut anything that doesn’t add meaning.
- **Honest beats sensational.** Never promise a result your content can’t deliver.
- **Test several.** Write three versions and pick the one you’d stop scrolling for.

What’s inside

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REFERENCE

Placeholder glossary

What to put in each fill-in field.

PLACEHOLDER	WHAT TO PUT THERE
[TOPIC]	The subject of your post — “meal prep”, “pricing”, “Instagram Stories”.
[ACTIVITY]	Something your audience does — “running”, “freelancing”, “learning Spanish”.
[NICHE]	Your field — “wedding photography”, “personal finance for students”.
[RESULT]	An outcome your audience wants — “sleep better”, “land your first client”.
[PROBLEM]	A specific struggle — “losing motivation after two weeks”.
[GOAL]	What your audience is trying to achieve.
[NUMBER]	A specific number. Odd numbers and small numbers tend to read naturally.
[TIME PERIOD]	A length of time — “30 days”, “six months”, “a year”.
[SITUATION]	Where your viewer is right now — “if you’re about to quit your job”.
[ACTION]	Something your viewer is about to do.
[THING]	An object, piece of work or result you can show.
[COMMON ADVICE]	Advice everyone in your niche repeats.
[OPINION]	A view you genuinely hold and can explain.
[EMOTION]	How your audience feels — overwhelmed, stuck, behind.
[X]	A habit or action you want people to stop.
[BEFORE]	The starting situation, described specifically.
[AFTER]	The improved situation, described specifically.
[STARTING POINT]	Where you (or a customer) began.
[OPPORTUNITY]	Something you were offered and turned down.
[DECISION]	A choice your audience is about to make.
[NEXT STEP]	The next stage in your audience’s journey.
[COMMON REQUIREMENT]	Something people believe they need before they start.
[POPULAR TREND]	A trend or method everyone seems to be using.
[EXPENSIVE THING]	Gear, software or a course people assume they need.
[COMMON SACRIFICE]	Something people assume they must give up.

STYLE 01 • 7 HOOKS

01

Curiosity

Open a gap between what the viewer knows and what they want to know.
Always deliver the answer — curiosity without a payoff feels like clickbait.

01 Nobody tells you this about [TOPIC]...

EXAMPLE Nobody tells you this about freelancing: the hardest part isn't finding clients.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, TikTok, carousel covers

02 I tried [ACTIVITY] for [TIME PERIOD]. Here's what actually happened.

EXAMPLE I tried batch-creating my content for 30 days. Here's what actually happened.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, TikTok, YouTube Shorts

03 The [TOPIC] advice I'd delete from the internet.

EXAMPLE The budgeting advice I'd delete from the internet.

WORKS WELL FOR Talking-head video, carousel cover

04 There's a reason your [TOPIC] isn't working — and it's not what you think.

EXAMPLE There's a reason your sourdough isn't rising — and it's not your starter.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, TikTok

05 [TIME PERIOD] of [ACTIVITY] taught me something no course did.

EXAMPLE Six years of wedding photography taught me something no course did.

WORKS WELL FOR LinkedIn opener, storytelling Reel

06 Most people skip this step in [ACTIVITY]. It's the one that matters most.

EXAMPLE Most people skip this step when painting a room. It's the one that matters most.

WORKS WELL FOR Tutorial Reels, carousels

07 If you [SITUATION], watch this before you [ACTION].

EXAMPLE If you're about to raise your prices, watch this before you announce it.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, TikTok

STYLE 02 • 7 HOOKS

02

Educational

Promise a clear, specific piece of learning. The more concrete the promise, the stronger the hook.

08 Here's how to [RESULT] in [NUMBER] simple steps.

EXAMPLE Here's how to plan a week of family meals in 4 simple steps.

WORKS WELL FOR Carousel covers, tutorial Reels

09 [TOPIC], explained in under 60 seconds.

EXAMPLE Compound interest, explained in under 60 seconds.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, TikTok, YouTube Shorts

10 The simplest way to [RESULT] — even if you're a complete beginner.

EXAMPLE The simplest way to start journaling — even if you're a complete beginner.

WORKS WELL FOR Carousels, Reels

11 Save this before your next [ACTIVITY].

EXAMPLE Save this before your next job interview.

WORKS WELL FOR Checklist carousels

12 You don't need [EXPENSIVE THING] to [RESULT]. You need this.

EXAMPLE You don't need a ring light to film good videos. You need a window.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, carousels

13 Here's the exact process I use to [RESULT].

EXAMPLE Here's the exact process I use to write a newsletter in one hour.

WORKS WELL FOR Carousels, LinkedIn posts

14 If you only learn one thing about [TOPIC], make it this.

EXAMPLE If you only learn one thing about houseplants, make it this.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, static posts

STYLE 03 • 6 HOOKS

03

Problem

Name the struggle in the words your audience uses. When people feel understood, they keep reading.

15 Struggling to [GOAL]? Start here.

EXAMPLE Struggling to run 5K without stopping? Start here.

WORKS WELL FOR Carousel covers, Reels

16 If [PROBLEM] keeps happening, this is probably why.

EXAMPLE If your clients keep paying late, this is probably why.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, LinkedIn posts

17 Tired of [PROBLEM]? Try this instead.

EXAMPLE Tired of rewriting the same email ten times? Try this instead.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, TikTok

18 This is for anyone who feels [EMOTION] about [TOPIC].

EXAMPLE This is for anyone who feels overwhelmed by their inbox.

WORKS WELL FOR Captions, talking-head videos

19 [PROBLEM] isn't a motivation problem. It's a system problem.

EXAMPLE Skipping workouts isn't a motivation problem. It's a system problem.

WORKS WELL FOR LinkedIn posts, Reels

20 Still dealing with [PROBLEM] after trying everything? Check this first.

EXAMPLE Still dealing with a slow laptop after trying everything? Check this first.

WORKS WELL FOR Tutorial Reels, carousels

STYLE 04 • 6 HOOKS

04

Mistake

People are wired to avoid losses. Pointing out a mistake — kindly — makes viewers check whether they're making it.

21 Stop doing [X] if you want [RESULT].

EXAMPLE Stop posting without a plan if you want consistent engagement.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, carousel covers

22 [NUMBER] mistakes beginners make when [ACTIVITY].

EXAMPLE 3 mistakes beginners make when learning guitar.

WORKS WELL FOR Carousels, Reels

23 I made this [TOPIC] mistake for years. Don't repeat it.

EXAMPLE I made this pricing mistake for years. Don't repeat it.

WORKS WELL FOR Talking-head Reels, LinkedIn

24 The most expensive mistake in [NICHE] is also the most common.

EXAMPLE The most expensive mistake in home renovation is also the most common.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, LinkedIn posts

25 If you're doing [ACTIVITY] like this, you're making it harder than it needs to be.

EXAMPLE If you're meal prepping like this, you're making it harder than it needs to be.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, TikTok

26 Avoid this if you're new to [NICHE].

EXAMPLE Avoid this if you're new to dog training.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, carousel covers

STYLE 05 · 6 HOOKS

05

Story

A story hook drops the viewer into a moment. Start as close to the action as you can.

27 I wish I knew this when I started [ACTIVITY].

EXAMPLE I wish I knew this when I started selling handmade jewelry.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, carousels, LinkedIn

28 The day I almost quit [ACTIVITY]...

EXAMPLE The day I almost quit teaching yoga...

WORKS WELL FOR Storytime Reels, captions

29 A client asked me something last week that I can't stop thinking about.

EXAMPLE A client asked me something last week that I can't stop thinking about: "Why do you still do this by hand?"

WORKS WELL FOR LinkedIn posts, talking-head videos

30 [TIME PERIOD] ago, I was [STARTING POINT]. Here's what changed.

EXAMPLE Two years ago, I was editing videos on a borrowed laptop. Here's what changed.

WORKS WELL FOR Carousels, Reels

31 This is the most honest thing I've shared about [TOPIC].

EXAMPLE This is the most honest thing I've shared about running a small café.

WORKS WELL FOR Captions, LinkedIn posts

32 I said no to [OPPORTUNITY]. Here's why.

EXAMPLE I said no to my biggest client offer this year. Here's why.

WORKS WELL FOR LinkedIn posts, Reels

STYLE 06 • 6 HOOKS

06

Contrarian

Challenge a common belief — respectfully and with a reason. Only use opinions you actually hold.

33 Unpopular opinion: [COMMON ADVICE] is overrated.

EXAMPLE Unpopular opinion: waking up at 5 a.m. is overrated.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, static posts

34 Everyone says [COMMON ADVICE]. I disagree.

EXAMPLE Everyone says you should post every day. I disagree.

WORKS WELL FOR LinkedIn posts, Reels

35 You don't need [COMMON REQUIREMENT] to [RESULT].

EXAMPLE You don't need a big following to sell your first digital product.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, carousel covers

36 [POPULAR TREND] isn't for everyone — and that's fine.

EXAMPLE Minimalist interiors aren't for everyone — and that's fine.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, captions

37 The most repeated advice about [TOPIC] is also the least helpful.

EXAMPLE The most repeated advice about networking is also the least helpful.

WORKS WELL FOR LinkedIn posts, talking-head videos

38 Hot take: [OPINION]. Here's my reasoning.

EXAMPLE Hot take: most small businesses don't need a website on day one. Here's my reasoning.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, LinkedIn posts

STYLE 07 • 6 HOOKS

07

List

Numbers set expectations. Viewers know how long the content is and what they'll get.

39 **[NUMBER] [TOPIC] tips I'd give my beginner self.**

EXAMPLE 5 photography tips I'd give my beginner self.

WORKS WELL FOR Carousels, Reels

40 **[NUMBER] tools that make [ACTIVITY] easier.**

EXAMPLE 4 tools that make planning content easier.

WORKS WELL FOR Carousels

41 **[NUMBER] signs you're ready to [NEXT STEP].**

EXAMPLE 3 signs you're ready to hire your first employee.

WORKS WELL FOR Carousels, LinkedIn posts

42 **[NUMBER] things I stopped doing to [RESULT].**

EXAMPLE 6 things I stopped doing to get more focused work done.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, carousels

43 **[NUMBER] questions to ask before you [DECISION].**

EXAMPLE 7 questions to ask before you sign a lease.

WORKS WELL FOR Carousels, LinkedIn document posts

44 **My [NUMBER]-step checklist for [ACTIVITY].**

EXAMPLE My 5-step checklist for launching a workshop.

WORKS WELL FOR Checklist carousels

STYLE 08 • 6 HOOKS

08

Before / After

Contrast creates instant interest. Show a real change and be honest about what it took.

45 Before: [BEFORE]. After: [AFTER]. Here's what changed.

EXAMPLE Before: three hours writing captions every week. After: forty minutes. Here's what changed.

WORKS WELL FOR Carousels, Reels

46 What my [THING] looked like on day 1 vs. day [NUMBER].

EXAMPLE What my handwriting looked like on day 1 vs. day 100.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, carousels

47 Same [THING], two approaches. Which one works better?

EXAMPLE Same product photo, two lighting setups. Which one works better?

WORKS WELL FOR Carousels, Reels

48 This is what [RESULT] actually looks like behind the scenes.

EXAMPLE This is what a "finished" kitchen renovation actually looks like behind the scenes.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, Story sequences

49 How I went from [STARTING POINT] to [RESULT] — without [COMMON SACRIFICE].

EXAMPLE How I went from zero savings to an emergency fund — without giving up weekends out.

WORKS WELL FOR Carousels, LinkedIn posts

50 Watch this [THING] go from [BEFORE] to [AFTER].

EXAMPLE Watch this tired armchair go from faded to fresh.

WORKS WELL FOR Reels, TikTok